

General Education Reflection

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The general education courses at Iowa State have really helped me develop as a professional engineer. These classes have given me the opportunity to become a more well rounded person as well as an engineer. This reflection will give the reader insight into a few different general education classes that I have taken at Iowa State that have given me a proper insight into what other majors have to offer and how they have helped me grow in my profession.

The first part of this reflection will go over what I have learned from the courses themselves and how they have helped me in engineering in terms of problem solving and innovation. The first thing that comes to mind in this regard is my RUS3750: Russia Today course. This class made it so I had to write lengthy papers every week for an entire summer. This class was taken during the summer between my sophomore and junior year at Iowa State. Along with this summer course, I also had a full-time internship in Kansas City. I think that this course helped me develop my time management skills. I'll be honest, the last thing that I wanted to do after a long day's work was type a few page paper about historical Russian issues. However, it made me value my time even more and made it so my work was done in a fashion to where I earned an A in the course. Also, this class gave me an insight to what current events are facing the people of Russia to this day. This includes the communist regime of Vladimir Putin and the economic impacts that come along with it. From an engineering standpoint, learning about these international conflicts and the associated economic instability can absolutely affect the semiconductor market.

The next course that really made an impact on me was my RELIG210: Religion in America course at Iowa State. This class dove into the diverse aspects of each religion that is practiced within the United States. This ranges from Christianity and Catholicism to Islam and Hinduism. This class really gave me the ability to see problems from different perspectives. We are obviously not the only people in the world, and everyone comes from a different walk of life. Learning about each individual religion gave me an insight as to how a different person may perceive a problem and how another person may view it. This class taught me that every person will have a different opinion on a problem or subject no matter who it is. Furthermore, when an engineer is designing a product, they must take into account their user's different backgrounds and differing needs. If they don't consider this, not as many people may want to purchase that product.

Another course that I would like to highlight is a course that I am currently taking. This class is HSPM3830: Wine and Spirits in Hospitality Management. This class has already taught me that service means everything. All of the teaching assistants within the classroom always have a smile on their face and are ready to ask any questions that anyone may have. I think that this general education course has taught me that at the end of the day, we are all here to serve.

This includes our clients along with our fellow employees and teammates. Also, it has given me the knowledge to form a connection with anyone I meet who is fond of wine. I truly believe that you can talk to anyone if you form a connection with them. After that connection is made, it is much easier to work alongside them or do business with them. This can be seen in an engineer's life when they have to work with a team. If they do not have a common goal of service for their clients, they will most likely not work well together at all.

In conclusion, the general education courses at Iowa State have helped me grow as a person. These classes are what give students the opportunity to learn about something that is not within the scope of their major. They provide students with different perspectives, ways to solve problems, and different methodologies for innovation. I am very grateful for all of the general education courses that I have taken at Iowa State, and I would recommend them to anyone.